

The \$2,000 on satcllp.com, traced to the law that put it there

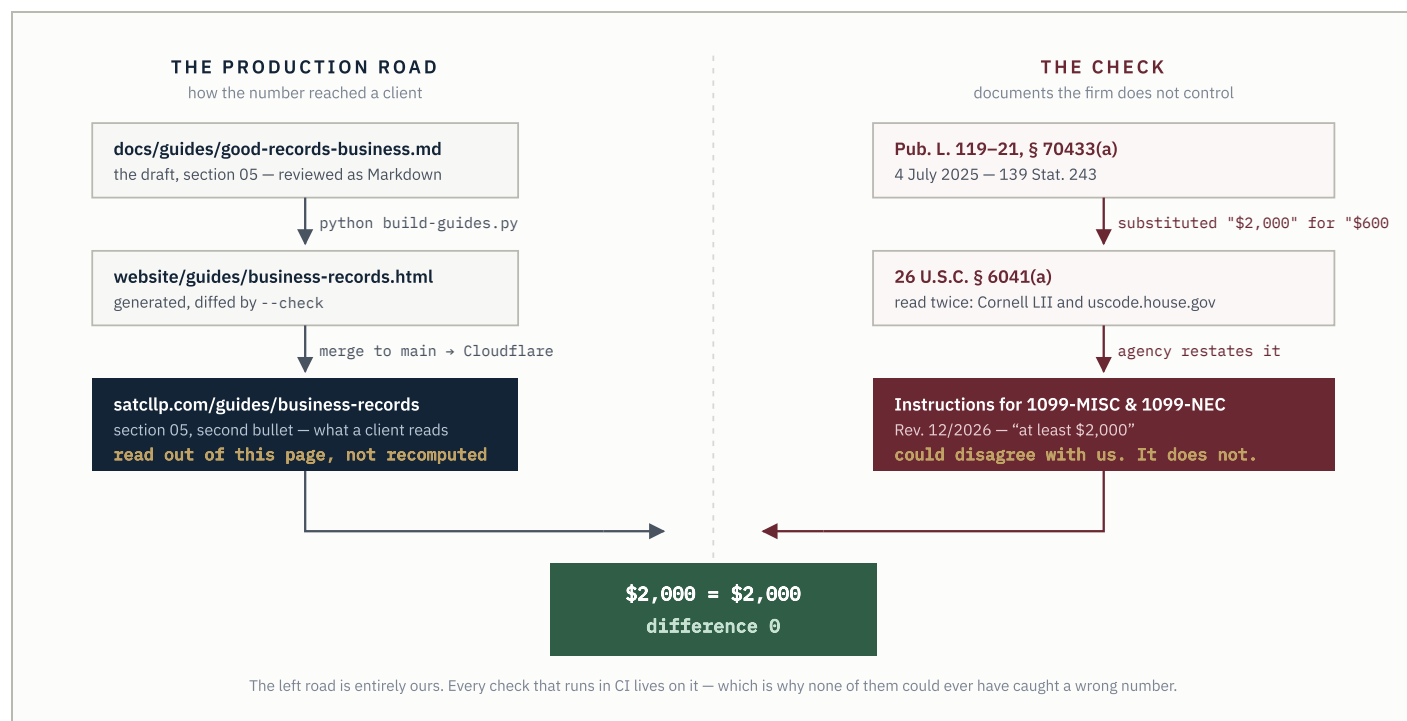
One figure, one bullet, proved link by link against two federal sources neither the firm nor I control. Everything below was executed on 7 September 2026, not described.

TIED

All four claims in the bullet agree with the U.S. Code and the IRS instructions.
Difference: 0. Three things the page does not say turned up on the way, and they are in § 08.

01 HOW THE DOTS CONNECT

Two roads carry the same number. The one on the left is how it got onto the page. The one on the right is how it was checked. They meet at the bottom, and only the right-hand road touches a document the firm does not control — which is what makes this evidence rather than a second opinion from the same source.



Why the right-hand road is the whole point. `copy.spec.py`, `tenets.spec.py` and `build-guides.py --check` all sit on the left road. They prove the published page agrees with the draft. A draft with the wrong number in it passes every one of them — and did: this figure read `$600` until a source pass caught it. Only the right-hand road can disagree.

WHERE THE READER SEES IT

<https://satcllp.com/guides/business-records.html> — section *05 · People you paid*, second bullet. Opened in Chrome on 7 September 2026 and read off the rendered page. **Not** read out of the Markdown draft, not out of the generated HTML in the repository, and not recomputed: the value on the `ours` side of link 5 is the one a client's browser painted.

How it was located, so a reader can repeat it exactly:

```
document.querySelectorAll('li') → the one whose text contains "1099-NEC"
```

ARTIFACT	SECTION	READ ON	FIGURE
Published web page	05, bullet 2	7 Sep 2026	\$2,000

04 Miles, home office, meals

- **Miles.** Written and kept as you drive: date, distance, and the reason for the trip.
- **The car method is a one-time choice.** Standard mileage has to be picked in the first year the car is used for the business. A leased car stays on that method for the whole lease, renewals included.
- **Home office.** The square footage of the room and of the house, plus the year's bills for the house — utilities and insurance to start with. What counts here shifts, so send more than you think we need and ask us if you are unsure.
- **Meals.** A receipt does not carry who was there or why. Write it on the receipt at the time.

05 People you paid

- Ask for a W-9 before the first payment, not in January.
- \$2,000 or more to someone who is not an employee usually means a 1099-NEC. It is due both to them and to the IRS by January 31. That threshold was \$600 until recently and it rises with inflation from 2027, so ask rather than assume it.
- Schedule C asks on the form itself whether you made payments that required a 1099. It is a question the return has to answer either way.

06 If it is a partnership or a corporation

- The return is due March 15 for a calendar year, and the owners' K-1s are due on that date too. If March 15 is a weekend or a holiday it moves to the next working day.
- So the company's books decide when its owners can file, not just when the company can.

- Past a certain size the return carries a balance sheet, which means year-end balances have to be right rather than close.
- If you own more than 2% of an S corporation and it pays for your health insurance, that amount belongs in your W-2 wages. Fixing it after the W-2 has gone out means reissuing forms.

- \$2,000 or more to someone who is not an employee usually means a 1099-NEC. It is due both to them and to the IRS by January 31. That threshold was \$600 until recently and it rises with inflation from 2027, so ask rather than assume it.

Ours. The live page, with the bullet ringed, and the same bullet enlarged beneath it. Four separate claims sit in these three sentences: the **\$2,000** threshold, a **January 31** date owed to two different parties, the old **\$600** figure, and indexation **from 2027**. Each is tied out below.

03 LINK 2 · THE CALL

There is no API here — the figure is a sentence on a static page, so “the call” is the request that returns it. Both of these run as they stand:

```
curl -sS https://satcllp.com/guides/business-records.html | grep -o "\$2,000[^\<]*"
```

```
curl -sS https://www.irs.gov/instructions/i1099mec | grep -o "at least \$2,000 in"
```

04 LINK 3 · THE DERIVATION

What happens between the source and the page, stated so a person could redo it by hand. “The system computes it” would be the gap this document exists to close — here there is deliberately no computation at all, and that is the finding of the derivation.

1. A human wrote `$2,000` into `docs/guides/good-records-business.md`, section 05, after reading the IRS instructions.
2. `website/build-guides.py` renders that Markdown to `website/guides/business-records.html`. It **escapes and reflows text and changes no numbers** — there is no arithmetic anywhere in the path.
3. A merge to `main` publishes through Cloudflare Pages to the live domain.

So the number is a transcription, and its only failure mode is being out of date or mistyped. That is exactly what happened once already: it read `$600` — the figure that was correct for twenty-plus years and stopped being correct on 1 January 2026. No test in this repository can catch that class of error, because every test compares the page to the draft, and the draft was the thing that was wrong.

Three documents, from two branches of government, none of them the firm's. Each was fetched, opened, photographed, and the figure located on it — not summarised.

26 U.S.C. § 6041(a) — Information at source

All persons engaged in a trade or business and making payment in the course of such trade or business to another person, of rent, salaries, wages ... or other fixed or determinable gains, profits, and income ... of \$2,000 or more in any calendar year ... shall render a true and accurate return to the Secretary.

TITLE	SECTION	SUBSECTION	HEADING	READ ON
26 — Internal Revenue Code	§ 6041	(a)	Payments exceeding threshold	7 Sep 2026



26 U.S. Code § 6041 - Information at source

[U.S. Code](#)[Notes](#)[Authorities \(CFR\)](#)[prev](#) | [next](#)

(a) PAYMENTS EXCEEDING THRESHOLD

All persons engaged in a trade or business and making payment in the course of such trade or business to another person, of rent, salaries, wages, premiums, annuities, compensations, remunerations, emoluments, or other fixed or determinable gains, profits, and income (other than payments to which section 6042(a)(1), 6044(a)(1), 6047(e), 6049(a), or 6050N(a) applies, and other than payments with respect to which a statement is required under the authority of section 6042(a)(2), 6044(a)(2), or 6045), of \$2,000 or more in any calendar year, or, in the case of such payments made by the United States, the officers or employees of the United States having information as to such payments and required to make returns in regard thereto by the regulations hereinafter provided for, shall render a true and accurate return to the Secretary, under such regulations and in such form and manner and to such extent as may be prescribed by the Secretary, setting forth the amount of such gains, profits, and income (including a separate accounting of any such amounts reasonably designated as cash tips and the occupation described in section 224(d)(1) of the person receiving such tips and a separate accounting of any amount of qualified overtime compensation (as defined in section 225(c))), and the name and address of the recipient of such payment.

(b) COLLECTION OF FOREIGN ITEMS

In the case of collections of items (not payable in the United States) of interest upon the bonds of foreign countries and interest upon the bonds of and dividends from foreign corporations by any person undertaking as a matter of business or for profit the collection of foreign payments of such interest or dividends by means of coupons, checks, or bills of exchange, such person shall make a return according to the forms or regulations prescribed by the Secretary, setting forth the amount paid and the name and address of the

recipient of each such payment.

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Got
it!

section 6042(a)(2), 6044(a)(2), or 6045), of \$2,000 or more in any calendar year,

Legal Information Institute, Cornell Law School. The section's own title is in the same shot as the figure. Note the subsection heading, ringed: it reads **“Payments exceeding threshold”**. It used to read “Payments of \$600 or more” — source C shows the moment it changed.

Instructions for Forms 1099-MISC and 1099-NEC (Rev. 12/2026)

*File Form 1099-NEC, Nonemployee Compensation, for each person in the course of your business during the year to whom you have paid **at least \$2,000** in: Services performed by **someone who is not your employee** (including parts and materials) (box 1a).*

PUBLISHER	REVISION	HEADING	READ ON
Internal Revenue Service	12/2026	Specific Instructions for Form 1099-NEC	7 Sep 2026

MISC, Form W-2, or Form W-2c for a prior year. Also, do not include amounts that are considered to be subject to a substantial risk of forfeiture for purposes of section 409A. For additional information, see Regulations sections 1.409A-1 through 1.409A-6; Notice 2008-113, available at [IRS.gov/irb/2008-51_IRB#NOT-2008-113](https://www.irs.gov/irb/2008-51_IRB#NOT-2008-113); Notice 2008-115; Notice 2010-6, available at [IRS.gov/irb/2010-03_IRB#NOT-2010-6](https://www.irs.gov/irb/2010-03_IRB#NOT-2010-6); and Notice 2010-80, available at [IRS.gov/irb/2010-51_IRB#NOT-2010-80](https://www.irs.gov/irb/2010-51_IRB#NOT-2010-80).

Boxes 16–18. State Information

These boxes are provided for your convenience only and need not be completed for the IRS. Use the state information boxes to report payments for up to two states. Keep the information for each state separated by the dash line. If you withheld state income tax on this payment, you may enter it in box 16. In box 17, enter the abbreviated name of the state and the payer's state identification number. The state number is the payer's identification number assigned by the individual state. In box 18, you may enter the amount of the state payment.

If a state tax department requires that you send them a paper copy of this form, use Copy 1 to provide information to the state tax department. Give Copy 2 to the recipient for use in filing the recipient's state income tax return.

Specific Instructions for Form 1099-NEC

File Form 1099-NEC, Nonemployee Compensation, for each person in the course of your business during the year to whom you have paid at least \$2,000 in:

1. 1. Services performed by someone who is not your employee (including parts and materials) ([box 1a](#)); or
2. 1. Payments to an attorney ([box 1a](#)). (See [Payments to attorneys](#), later.)

File Form 1099-NEC or Form 1099-MISC to report sales totaling \$5,000 or more of consumer products to a person on a buy-sell, a deposit-commission, or other commission basis for resale.

Caution: If you use Form 1099-NEC to report sales totaling \$5,000 or more, then you are required to file Form 1099-NEC with the IRS by January 31.

You must also file Form 1099-NEC for each person from whom you have withheld any federal income tax (report in [box 4](#)) under the backup withholding rules regardless of the amount of the payment.

Caution: Be sure to report each payment in the proper box because the IRS uses this information to determine whether the recipient has properly reported the payment.

Reportable payments to corporations. The following payments made to corporations must generally be reported on Form 1099-NEC.

- Attorneys' fees reported in [box 1a](#).

- Payments by a federal executive agency for services (vendors) reported in [box 1a](#).

Caution: Federal executive agencies may also have to file Form 8596, Information Return for Federal Contracts, and Form 8596-A, Quarterly Transmittal of Information Returns for Federal Contracts, if a contracted amount for personal services is more than \$25,000. See Rev. Rul. 2003-66, which is on page 1115 of Internal Revenue Bulletin 2003-26 at [IRS.gov/pub/irs-irbs/irb03-26.pdf](https://www.irs.gov/pub/irs-irbs/irb03-26.pdf) for details.

File Form 1099-NEC, Nonemployee Compensation, for each person in the course of your business during the year to whom you have paid at least \$2,000 in:

1. Services performed by someone who is not your employee (including parts and materials) ([box 1a](#)); or

The operative rule. This is the sentence a business owner is actually governed by, and it carries **both** halves of the guide's first claim: the amount, and that it applies to someone who is not your employee.

- [Instructions for Forms 1099-MISC and 1099-NEC - Introductory Material](#)
- [Instructions for Forms 1099-MISC and 1099-NEC - Main Contents](#)
- [Instructions for Forms 1099-MISC and 1099-NEC - Additional Material](#)

Instructions for Forms 1099-MISC and 1099-NEC (12/2026)

Miscellaneous Information and Nonemployee Compensation

Section references are to the Internal Revenue Code unless otherwise noted.

Revised: 12/2026

Instructions for Forms 1099-MISC and 1099-NEC - Introductory Material

Future Developments

For the latest information about developments related to Forms 1099-MISC and 1099-NEC and their instructions, such as legislation enacted after they were published, go to [IRS.gov/Form1099MISC](https://www.irs.gov/Form1099MISC) or [IRS.gov/Form1099NEC](https://www.irs.gov/Form1099NEC).

You can get Pub. 1099, General Instructions for Certain Information Returns at [IRS.gov/Pub1099](https://www.irs.gov/Pub1099).

What's New

Address fields. For the Payer's and Recipient's information, we separated the address fields into individual entry boxes.

E-filing returns. The Taxpayer First Act of 2019 authorized the Department of the Treasury and the IRS to issue regulations that reduce the 250-return e-file threshold. T.D. 9972, published February 23, 2023, lowered the e-file threshold to 10 (calculated by aggregating all information returns), effective for information returns required to be filed on or after January 1, 2024. Go to [IRS.gov/InfoReturn](https://www.irs.gov/InfoReturn) for e-file options.

Increase in threshold for requiring filing of certain information returns and backup withholding.

For tax years beginning after 2025, the minimum threshold amount for reporting certain payments

required to be reported on certain information returns and/or perform backup withholding on those payments increased to \$2,000 and may be adjusted for inflation beginning in calendar year 2027.

New boxes 1b and 13a. P.L. 119-21, section 70201, requires the reporting of cash tips. These new boxes were added to facilitate this reporting requirement for Forms 1099-NEC and 1099-MISC. For more information, see the specific instructions for these boxes, later.

New boxes 1c and 13b. Use the Treasury Tipped Occupation Code(s) to identify the tipped occupation(s) for Forms 1099-NEC and 1099-MISC. For more information, see the specific instructions for these boxes, later.

For tax years beginning after 2025, the minimum threshold amount for reporting certain payments required to be reported on certain information returns and/or perform backup withholding on those payments increased to \$2,000 and may be adjusted for inflation beginning in calendar year 2027.

The same page's identity, in the same shot as the change. Title, (12/2026) and Revised: 12/2026 are all visible above the ringed paragraph — which carries the guide's fourth claim in the agency's own words: “may be adjusted for inflation beginning in calendar year 2027.”

26 U.S.C. § 6041, Editorial Notes — Office of Law Revision Counsel

2025—*Subsec. (a). Pub. L. 119–21, §70433(e), substituted “exceeding threshold” for “of \$600 or more” in heading ... Pub. L. 119–21, §70433(a), substituted “\$2,000” for “\$600”.*

PUBLISHER	EDITION	PUBLIC LAW	ENACTED	STATUTES
OLRC, U.S. House	prelim, current	119–21, § 70433	4 July 2025	139 Stat. 243



Current



[<< Previous](#) [TITLE 26 / Subtitle F / CHAPTER 61 / Subchapter A / PART III / Subpart B / § 6041](#) [Next >>](#)

[\[Print\]](#) [\[Print selection\]](#)

[\[OLRC Home\]](#) [Help](#)

(g) Nonqualified deferred compensation

Subsection (a) shall apply to-

- (1) any deferrals for the year under a nonqualified deferred compensation plan (within the meaning of section 409A(d)), whether or not paid, except that this paragraph shall not apply to deferrals which are required to be reported under section 6051(a)(13) (without regard to any de minimis exception), and
- (2) any amount includible under section 409A and which is not treated as wages under section 3401(a).

(h) Inflation adjustment

In the case of any calendar year after 2026, the dollar amount in subsection (a) shall be increased by an amount equal to-

- (1) such dollar amount, multiplied by
- (2) the cost-of-living adjustment determined under section 1(f)(3) for such calendar year, determined by substituting "calendar year 2025" for "calendar year 2016" in subparagraph (A)(ii) thereof.

If any increase under the preceding sentence is not a multiple of \$100, such increase shall be rounded to the nearest multiple of \$100.

(Aug. 16, 1954, ch. 736, 68A Stat. 745 ; Pub. L. 87-834, §19(f), Oct. 16, 1962, 76 Stat. 1058 ; Pub. L. 94-455, title XIX, §1906(b)(13)(A), Oct. 4, 1976, 90 Stat. 1834 ; Pub. L. 95-600, title V, §501(b), Nov. 6, 1978, 92 Stat. 2878 ; Pub. L. 97-34, title VII, §723(b)(1), Aug. 13, 1981, 95 Stat. 344 ; Pub. L. 97-248, title III, §309(b)(1), Sept. 3, 1982, 96 Stat. 595 ; Pub. L. 98-369, div. A, title VII, §722(h)(4)(B), July 18, 1984, 98 Stat. 976 ; Pub. L. 99-514, title XV, §§1501(c)(1), 1523(b)(2), Oct. 22, 1986, 100 Stat. 2736 , 2748; Pub. L. 104-168, title XII, §1201(a)(1), July 30, 1996, 110 Stat. 1469 ; Pub. L. 108-173, title XII, §1203(a), Dec. 8, 2003, 117 Stat. 2480 ; Pub. L. 108-357, title VIII, §885(b)(3), Oct. 22, 2004, 118 Stat. 1640 ; Pub. L. 111-148, title IX, §9006(a), (b), Mar. 23, 2010, 124 Stat. 855 ; Pub. L. 111-240, title II, §2101(a), Sept. 27, 2010, 124 Stat. 2561 ; Pub. L. 112-9, §§2(a), (b), 3(a), Apr. 14, 2011, 125 Stat. 36 ; Pub. L. 119-21, title VII, §§70201(f)(1), 70202(c)(2), 70433(a), (b), (e), July 4, 2025, 139 Stat. 172 , 175, 243, 244.)

EDITORIAL NOTES

AMENDMENTS

2025-Subsec. (a). Pub. L. 119-21, §70433(e), substituted "exceeding threshold" for "of \$600 or more" in heading and "calendar year" for "taxable year" in text.

Pub. L. 119-21, §70433(a), substituted "\$2,000" for "\$600".

Pub. L. 119-21, §70202(c)(2)(A), which directed the insertion of "and a separate accounting of any amount of qualified overtime compensation (as defined in section 225(c))" after "occupation of the person receiving such tips", was executed by making the insertion after "occupation described in section 224(d)(1) of the person receiving such tips", to reflect the probable intent of Congress.

Pub. L. 119-21, §70201(f)(1)(A), inserted "(including a separate accounting of any such amounts reasonably designated as cash tips and the occupation described in section 224(d)(1) of the person receiving such tips)" after "such gains, profits, and income".

Subsec. (d)(3). Pub. L. 119-21, §70201(f)(1)(B), added par. (3).

Subsec. (d)(4). Pub. L. 119-21, §70202(c)(2)(B), added par. (4).

Subsec. (h). Pub. L. 119-21, §70433(b), added subsec. (h).

2011-Subsec. (a). Pub. L. 112-9, §2(b), struck out "amounts in consideration for property," after "salaries, wages," "gross proceeds," after "emoluments, or other", and "gross proceeds," after "setting forth the amount of such".

Subsec. (h). Pub. L. 112-9, §3(a), struck out subsec. (h) which related to treatment of rental property expense payments.

Subsecs. (i), (j). Pub. L. 112-9, §2(a), struck out subsecs. (i) and (j) which read as follows:

"(i) APPLICATION TO CORPORATIONS.-Notwithstanding any regulation prescribed by the Secretary before the date of the enactment of this subsection, for purposes of this section the term 'person' includes any corporation that is not an organization exempt from tax under section 501(a).

"(j) REGULATIONS.-The Secretary may prescribe such regulations and other guidance as may be appropriate or necessary to carry out the purposes of this section, including rules to prevent duplicative reporting of transactions."

2025-Subsec. (a). Pub. L. 119-21, §70433(e), substituted "exceeding threshold" for "of \$600 or more" in heading and "calendar year" for "taxable year" in text.

Pub. L. 119-21, §70433(a), substituted "\$2,000" for "\$600".

One image proves three of the four claims. The breadcrumb across the top carries the full citation — **Title 26 / Subtitle F / Chapter 61 / Subchapter A / Part III / Subpart B / § 6041**. The ringed notes say the figure *is* \$2,000 and *was* \$600. The credit line above them names the public law and the date. This is the source `website/HANDOFF.md` recorded as unfetchable; it was tested and it opened.

(h) Inflation adjustment

In the case of any calendar year after 2026, the dollar amount in subsection (a) shall be increased by an amount equal to-

(1) such dollar amount, multiplied by

(2) the cost-of-living adjustment determined under section 1(f)(3) for such calendar year, determined by substituting "calendar year 2025" for "calendar year 2016" in subparagraph (A)(ii) thereof.

§ 6041(h), from the upper half of the same page. *"In the case of any calendar year after 2026..."* — after 2026 is 2027 onward, which is what the guide says. The rounding rule is there too: any increase is rounded to the nearest **\$100**, so the next figure a client sees will be \$2,000 or \$2,100, never \$2,043.

Both numbers adjacent, before any verdict. The verdict below is read off this block, not written ahead of it.

ours satcllp.com/guides/business-records — section 05, bullet 2, as rendered	\$2,000
source A 26 U.S.C. § 6041(a), “of \$2,000 or more in any calendar year”	\$2,000
source B IRS Instructions 1099-MISC/NEC Rev. 12/2026, “at least \$2,000”	\$2,000
difference	0

The four sameness checks, before TIED may be written

CHECK	SAME?	HOW IT WAS ESTABLISHED
Entity	YES	Not an entity figure. Both sides describe the same class of payer: a person making payments in the course of a trade or business. The guide's bullet and § 6041(a) use materially the same words.
Period	YES	Today is 7 September 2026, inside calendar year 2026. § 70433(f) makes the change apply to payments made after 31 December 2025 , so every 2026 payment is in scope. The page carries no year, and needs none while the figure holds.
Basis	SEE §8	Both sides mean the same thing for a calendar-year filer, and § 70433(e) changed § 6041(a) from “taxable year” to “ calendar year ”, which is the basis an information return runs on anyway. But the IRS's <i>What's New</i> frames the switchover as “tax years beginning after 2025” while the statute's effective-date note says “payments made after Dec. 31, 2025”. Those are different tests. Recorded rather than smoothed over.
Units	YES	US dollars, actual, on every side. No thousands, no scaling. The figure is a statutory threshold, not a measured amount.

The other three claims in the same bullet

CLAIM ON THE PAGE	VERDICT	SOURCE, LOCATED
“That threshold was \$600 until recently”	TIED	OLRC amendment note: <i>Pub. L. 119–21, §70433(a), substituted “\$2,000” for “\$600”</i> . The word <i>recently</i> is carried by the enactment date, 4 July 2025.
“it rises with inflation from 2027 ”	TIED	§ 6041(h): “ <i>In the case of any calendar year after 2026...</i> ” Corroborated by the IRS: “ <i>may be adjusted for inflation beginning in calendar year 2027.</i> ”

“due both to **them** and to the **IRS** by **TIED, with a gap** § 6071(c), restated in the instructions: *“file Form 1099-NEC on or before January 31.”* Both halves — recipient and IRS — are one date. **But see § 8.**

07 ROSTER, WITH ITS DENOMINATOR

This exhibit is a sample of one bullet, not a survey of the guides. The denominator matters more than the numerator.

```
Bullet tied out: 1 of 1      section 05, bullet 2, good-records-business.md
Claims in it:   4 of 4      TIED ($2,000 · was $600 · indexes from 2027 · January 31)
DIFFERS        0
COULD NOT      0

Other numeric claims on the same page:  NOT CHECKED, 5 of them
$5,000 consumer products · March 15 entity return · 2% S corp
health insurance · payroll records four years · 30-day notice clock
Other two guides:                      NOT CHECKED
```

Five other figures on this one page were not checked and carry whatever verdict the last full

verify_sources.py run gave them. That run was not repeated here. “Not checked” is a different fact from “checked and clean”, and only one of them is true of those five.

FINDING 1 • THE PAGE STATES A DATE THAT HAS MOVED IN EACH OF THE LAST TWO SEASONS, AND DOES NOT SAY IT MOVES

The bullet says the form is due “**by January 31**” and stops. January 31 is the statutory date and the page is not wrong. But the IRS's own General Instructions, for the season just gone, say:

File and furnish a copy of Form 1099-NEC on paper or electronically by February 2, 2026.

General Instructions for Certain Information Returns (2025), section **C. When To File** — because 31 January 2026 fell on a Saturday.

And the rule that moved it is on the same page of the same source:

before the due date. If the regular due date falls on a Saturday, Sunday, or legal holiday in the District of Columbia or where the return is to be filed, file by the next business day. A business day is any day that is not a Saturday, Sunday, or legal holiday in the District of Columbia or where the return is to be filed.

It moves again next season. 31 January 2027 is a Sunday, so the date a reader of this page will actually face is **Monday 1 February 2027**.

Why this is worth raising rather than shrugging at. The firm gave a standing instruction on exactly this, recorded at C001 in `docs/guides/FIRM-REVIEW.md`: “*we can use January 31 and other standard dates and then say that you have to account for weekends and holidays as well.*” The individual guide obeys it — “*These dates move. When one falls on a weekend or a federal holiday it becomes the next working day.*” And **this page obeys it once and not twice**: section 06 says “*If March 15 is a weekend or a holiday it moves to the next working day*”, while section 05's January 31 gets no such note. One page, two dates, one rule stated.

Not fixed here. It is a change to client-facing copy, so it is the firm's, and it is written up as a decision rather than applied.

FINDING 2 • THE AGENCY AND THE STATUTE DESCRIBE THE SWITCHOVER DIFFERENTLY, AND THE REPOSITORY QUOTES THE LOOSER ONE

`docs/guides/SOURCES.md` justifies the \$2,000 figure by quoting the IRS: “*For tax years beginning after 2025...*”. The statute's own effective-date note says something narrower: the amendment is “*applicable with respect to payments made after Dec. 31, 2025*” (§ 70433(f)).

Those are different tests — one keys on a tax year, the other on a payment date. **They give the same answer here**, because § 70433(e) simultaneously changed § 6041(a) to read *calendar year*, and an information return runs on the calendar year regardless of the payer's fiscal year. **The figure is not affected and nothing on the website is wrong.** But the row in `SOURCES.md` rests on the paraphrase rather than on the rule, and that is the kind of citation that reads as verified right up until a fiscal-year payer asks about it.

FINDING 3 · A SOURCE RECORDED AS UNREACHABLE WAS REACHABLE

`website/HANDOFF.md` § 6 and `docs/guides/SOURCES-entity-choice.md` both record `uscode.house.gov` as blocked — “*the only source in either file that still cannot be fetched from here*”. It was tested once and it opened, and it turned out to be the single most useful document in this exhibit: the amendment notes there prove *three* of the bullet's four claims in one image, which no other source did. **The obstacle was real when it was written and it is a property of a container, not of the source.** Worth re-testing rather than inheriting.

09 WHAT I GOT WRONG

Recorded because a tie-out that hides its own misses is worth nothing.

- **I read the first source into a wedged browser tab and did not notice for six attempts.** The IRS page would not scroll — `window.scrollTo`, `scrollIntoView`, an anchor and a direct `scrollTop` all reported success and moved nothing, because the tab's renderer had timed out earlier in the session. A fresh tab worked first time. Had I captured a screenshot without checking where it landed, the exhibit would have carried a photograph of the wrong part of the right page, which looks exactly like evidence.
- **My first attempt at marking the IRS page matched a wrapper element** and highlighted the entire document body yellow, including the federal-website banner. That capture was discarded rather than cropped, because a page that has been restyled wholesale by the person photographing it is not a photograph of that page.

10 WHAT THIS DOES NOT PROVE

- **That the guides are right.** One bullet on one of three pages was checked. Five other numeric claims sit on this same page untouched by this exercise.
- **That the figure will still be right in January.** § 6041(h) indexes it from calendar year 2027, so a reader in 2027 may be governed by \$2,000 or by \$2,100, and **nothing on the website or in this repository watches for that.** The page's hedge — “*so ask rather than assume it*” — is currently the whole of the control.
- **That \$2,000 is the right threshold for every 1099-NEC.** It is the threshold under § 6041(a) for services by a non-employee, which is what the bullet describes. Direct sales are \$5,000 and backup withholding has its own rule; neither was checked.
- **That the words around the figure are good copy.** This is an accuracy exercise. The firm has still not read these three pages end to end, and said they would before publication.
- **Anything about the other two guides.** Not opened for this.

11 RUN IT YOURSELF

Every command below has the real values in it. Nothing to fill in. A reader who follows these should land on the same numbers this document reports — and if they do not, the document is wrong and they have found it.

1 • Read what the page says today

```
curl -sS https://satcllp.com/guides/business-records.html | grep -o "\$2,000[^\<]*"
```

Expect the bullet, beginning `$2,000 or more to someone who is not an employee`.

2 • Read what the IRS says today

```
curl -sS https://www.irs.gov/instructions/i1099mec | grep -o "at least \$2,000 in"
```

Expect one match. If it returns nothing, the instructions have been revised and **the page needs re-checking before the next filing season**.

3 • Read what the law says today

```
curl -sS "https://uscode.house.gov/view.xhtml?req=granuleid:USC-prelim-title26-section6041&num=0&edition=prelim" | grep -o '\$2,000 or more in any calendar year'
```

4 • Read the amendment that changed it

```
curl -sS "https://uscode.house.gov/view.xhtml?req=granuleid:USC-prelim-title26-section6041&num=0&edition=prelim" | grep -o 'substituted &quot;\$2,000&quot; for &quot;\$600&quot;'
```

Expect: `substituted "$2,000" for "$600"`. That single line is the proof that the old figure was \$600 and the new one is \$2,000, published by the Office of Law Revision Counsel rather than by us.

5 • Check whether the January 31 date moves this year

```
python -c "import datetime; d=datetime.date(2027,1,31); print(d.strftime('%A'))"
```

Expect `Sunday` — so the real date is Monday 1 February 2027. Change the year to check any season.

6 • Re-cut the evidence from the captures

```
cd docs/tie-out/1099-nec-threshold-2026-09-07 && python make-crops.py
```